Data & AI Readiness Tool: full user flow, scoring and follow-up emails

For review by Irfan and the engineering team · 13 November 2026

1. The journey at a glance

Stage	What the user sees	What we ask for
0. Landing	"Is your data ready for AI?", the four result types, "about 6 minutes, results before any form"	Nothing
1. Tailor	3 context questions (X1–X3)	Nothing personal
2. Assessment	18 scored questions in three sections: Data, AI, Safe to Scale. Then timeline (T1) and data pain (P1)	Nothing personal
3. Instant results	Result type + headline, the 2×2, three scores, six domain bars, blocker names (not the fixes), primary CTA, "Get the full report"	Nothing
4. Full report	PDF: each domain explained, the fix for every blocker, a 90-day first move, relevant proof	First name, work email, company, company size, country (pre-filled), consent
5. Follow-up email	Sent the moment the report is requested. One email per diagnosis (section 6)	—
6. Review	30-minute Data & AI Readiness Review with an xLoop engineer	Calendar booking (phone optional)

- Every scored question also offers **"Not sure"**
- **Exception (NEPRA):** Energy & utilities + Pakistan shows the NEPRA page with phone +92 21 3586 9200 and xsecurity@xloopdigital.com only, no form and no booking link

2. Stage 1: context questions (not scored)

Intro line: *"Three quick questions so we can tailor your result."*

X1. What are you trying to get to first?

- One trusted set of numbers we can report on
- Forecasting and decision support from our data
- Getting off legacy systems that hold us back
- Answers and summaries from our own documents
- An assistant that handles customer questions
- Agents that complete multi-step work across systems
- Visual inspection or video analytics
- Not decided yet

Used for: report order, the initiative named in later questions and emails, the service page linked. "Not decided yet" caps the lead at priority B.

X2. Which best describes your role?

- CEO, MD or founder
- CIO, CTO, CDO or head of digital
- Head of data, analytics or BI
- CISO, head of security, risk or compliance
- Business unit or operations leader
- Engineering, product or platform lead
- Individual learner, or exploring an AI career

- Other

Used for: which score the report shows first (head of data sees Data first, CISO sees Safe first). Individual learners still get results but are excluded from the pipeline and offered xCelerate.

X3. Which industry are you in?

- Banking & financial services
- Energy & utilities
- Retail & eCommerce
- Healthcare
- Transport & logistics
- Mining & resources
- Government & public sector
- Other

3. Stage 2: the 18 scored questions

Each answer scores 0–3. **B** = blocker question. **Core** = in the 12-question short version.

Section A: Data Foundation

Data Access & Integration

ID	Question	0	1	2	3	Flags
D1.1	Where does the data your initiative needs live today?	Mostly in people's heads, email, spreadsheets or paper	Spread across systems and shared drives, with no clear owner	In known systems, but getting it out takes manual work	In known systems we can reach through APIs, exports or a data platform	B · Core
D1.2	How does data get from those systems to where it is actually used?	It doesn't; people pull it together by hand each time	Manual exports and spreadsheets, repeated every cycle	Some automated pipelines, the rest manual	Automated pipelines into a central platform, with alerts when they fail	Core
D1.3	Can the systems where work happens (CRM, ERP, core banking, ticketing) exchange data with new tools?	No; data moves by copy and paste	Our core platforms are old and have no APIs	Some have APIs, but every connection is a one-off project	Core systems have APIs, and there is a standard way to connect something new	—

Data Trust & Meaning

ID	Question	0	1	2	3	Flags
D2.1	If two teams report the same number this month, do they match? *(Helper: Revenue, customer count, claims, units shipped: whichever matters most to you.)*	No, and we have stopped expecting them to	Often not, and reconciling them takes days	Mostly, with known exceptions	Yes; there is one agreed source for the numbers that matter	B · Core
D2.2	Who is responsible for that data being correct and current?	No one	IT keeps the systems running, but nobody owns whether the data is right	Owners exist for major systems, informally	Named owners, with quality standards that are actually checked	Core
D2.3	What shape are the documents and records it relies on? *(Helper: Analytics and AI both work best on content they can search and read.)*	Mostly scanned PDFs, images or paper	A mix of formats, only some searchable	Mostly digital and searchable, but inconsistently labeled	Digital, searchable, and consistently labeled (dates, owners, document types)	—

Section B: AI Delivery

Use Case & Value

ID	Question	0	1	2	3	Flags
A1.1	How clearly is your priority initiative defined? *(Helper: The one you picked at the start.)*	We know we need to do something, but haven't picked it	We have a shortlist, with no single priority	One priority is chosen, but its success measure isn't agreed	One priority is chosen, with an agreed success measure (hours saved, response time, cost per case)	Core
A1.2	If the pilot works, who pays for the rollout?	No one has been asked yet	It would need a new budget request, with no named owner	A named executive owns it, but no budget is set aside	A named executive owns it, and budget is set aside for rollout, not just the pilot	B · Core
A1.3	What will you compare the result against to decide it worked?	Nothing defined; we would judge it informally	A rough sense of today's performance, not written down	Today's baseline is measured for part of the process	Today's baseline is measured, and we know the number that would justify scaling	—

Delivery Capability

ID	Question	0	1	2	3	Flags
A2.1	Who would build and look after it?	No one identified, in-house or through a partner	A few enthusiasts, alongside their day jobs	A dedicated team, but missing key skills (data engineering, LLM engineering)	A dedicated team with the skills needed, in-house or through a partner	B · Core
A2.2	What happened to your most recent data or AI project? *(Helper: Count a project as live only if it passed agreed checks for value, accuracy and who supports it.)*	We haven't run one yet	It stayed a demo, or a report nobody uses	It went live for one team but hasn't expanded	It went live and has been expanded or repeated elsewhere	Core
A2.3	How long does it take to get a new dashboard, model or feature to the people who need it?	We can't say; requests sit in a queue	Months, with manual releases	Weeks, with some automation	Days to weeks, with automated testing and release	—

Section C: Safe to Scale

Shadow AI & Data Protection

ID	Question	0	1	2	3	Flags
S1.1	If an employee pasted a client contract into a free public AI chatbot tomorrow, what would happen?	Nothing would stop it, and we wouldn't know	It's against policy, but nothing technical stops it	It's blocked on company devices, but we can't see what happens elsewhere	It's blocked or logged, and staff have an approved AI tool to use instead	B · Core
S1.2	Do you know which AI tools your teams are using today? *(Helper: Include browser extensions and AI features inside tools you already pay for.)*	No	Only the ones IT has bought	We have reviewed or surveyed usage at least once	We track usage continuously and keep an approved-tools list	Core
S1.3	If an assistant sat on top of your documents, could it respect who is allowed to see what?	No; permissions aren't consistent in the source systems	Only if we copied documents into a separate, restricted store	Permissions exist in the source systems, but we haven't tested carrying them through	Yes; access rights carry through, and we have tested it	—

Governance & Oversight

ID	Question	0	1	2	3	Flags
S2.1	Who can approve a new AI use case going live?	Anyone who can buy or build it	IT or security, informally, if they hear about it	There is a defined approval step, but it isn't always used	A defined approval step with business, security and legal input, used every time	B · Core

ID	Question	0	1	2	3	Flags
S2.2	Which rules apply to how you use data and AI, and are they mapped? *(Helper: For example data protection law (UAE or Saudi PDPL, GDPR), your sector regulator, the EU AI Act, or ISO/IEC 42001.)*	We haven't looked into it	We know data protection law applies, but haven't mapped it to AI	We have mapped the main obligations for our data and AI use	Mapped, owned, and aligned to a recognized framework such as ISO/IEC 42001 or NIST AI RMF	Core
S2.3	Before an AI answer reaches a customer or a decision, what checks it, and what happens if it is wrong?	Nothing checks it; we would find out when someone complained	People check answers when they have time, and fixes are ad hoc	Important answers are reviewed or tested and have an owner, but switching off has never been tested	Answers are checked against agreed thresholds before release, with an owner and a tested way to switch off or roll back	B

Closing questions (not scored)

T1. When would you like this working in production? Within 3 months · In 3–6 months · In 6–12 months · No date yet

P1. In the last 12 months, has missing, wrong or inconsistent data caused delays, errors or lost deals? Yes, often · Yes, sometimes · Rarely · No · Not sure

- "Yes, often" opens the report (and the email, see 6.4) with what bad data is costing them
- "No" with a low Data Foundation score: the report notes the cost may not be visible yet

4. Scoring mechanism

1. **Answer points:** 0–3 per question
2. **"Not sure":** left out of the domain's possible points (not scored 0). On a blocker question it still flags the blocker, because an unknown risk counts
3. **Domain %** = points earned ÷ (3 × questions answered in that domain)
4. **The three scores** = average of their two domains
   - Data Foundation = Data Access & Integration + Data Trust & Meaning
   - AI Delivery = Use Case & Value + Delivery Capability
   - Safe to Scale = Shadow AI & Data Protection + Governance & Oversight
5. **Overall readiness** = average of the three scores (weights 1.0 each, editable)
6. **Blockers:** 7 blocker questions (D1.1, D2.1, A1.2, A2.1, S1.1, S2.1, S2.3). Answered 0–1 or "Not sure" = blocker
7. **Priority domain** = lowest priority index, where index = domain % minus 1 if the domain has any blocker. Ties go in this order: Data Trust & Meaning, Data Access & Integration, Use Case & Value, Delivery Capability, Shadow AI & Data Protection, Governance & Oversight (data wins ties on purpose)
8. **Short version:** only the 12 Core questions count

Worked example (from the workbook)

- Answers give Data 39%, AI 72%, Safe 39%, overall 50%
- Result: **AI Ahead of the Data**, guardrails behind, 4 blockers, 1 "Not sure"
- Data Trust & Meaning and Shadow AI tie on the index (−0.67); the tie goes to data
- CTA: Book a 30-minute Data & AI Readiness Review, on the data analytics page

5. Results diagnosis

The four result types (Data vs AI, threshold 50% on each)

Result type	Rule	Headline on results page	What it means	First move in the report	Default page
Starting Out	Data < 50%, AI < 50%	Start with one question worth answering, and the data it needs.	Early on both sides. The first choices (which initiative, which data, who owns it) decide how the rest goes.	Pick one initiative with a named owner and a success measure, and scope only the data it needs.	/services/ai-consulting-and-development
Data Ready, AI Not Started	Data ≥ 50%, AI < 50%	Your data is in better shape than your use of it.	The foundation is there. Missing: a chosen initiative with an owner and a measure.	Pick the first use case your data can already support, and set the number that would justify scaling it.	/services/ai-consulting-and-development
AI Ahead of the Data	Data < 50%, AI ≥ 50%	You are ready to build on data that is not ready yet.	Intent, sponsor and often the team are there. The gap is underneath. This is where AI projects quietly stall.	Fix the specific data the initiative depends on, in parallel with a narrow pilot.	/services/data-analytics
Ready to Scale	Data ≥ 50%, AI ≥ 50%	The foundations are there. The question is what to scale first.	Ready on both sides. Anything flagged is what could slow the next rollout.	Choose the next initiative to scale, and test it against production controls first.	Initiative page from X1

Overlays (apply to any result type)

Overlay	Rule	Added line
Guardrails behind	Safe to Scale < 50%	"Your guardrails are behind your plans." Report puts the Safe fixes before rollout steps
Blockers found	1+ blockers	"[N] things are likely to stall this before it reaches production." CTA switches to the priority domain's CTA
Low visibility	3+ "Not sure"	"You weren't sure about [N] answers, which is worth knowing in itself."
Provisional	6+ "Not sure"	"You weren't sure about [N] answers, so treat these scores as a starting point."
Role order	From X2	Domain order in the report follows the role

Where each priority domain routes

Priority domain	Next step	Page
Data Trust & Meaning	30-minute Data & AI Readiness Review	/services/data-analytics
Data Access & Integration	30-minute Data & AI Readiness Review	/services/data-analytics
Use Case & Value	30-minute Data & AI Readiness Review	/services/ai-consulting-and-development
Delivery Capability	30-minute Data & AI Readiness Review	/services/cloud-and-hyperscaling
Shadow AI & Data Protection	AI Security Assessment	/services/ai-security-service
Governance & Oversight	AI Security Assessment	/services/ai-security-service

6. Follow-up emails

6.1 How the emails are put together

- **Trigger:** the moment someone requests the full report. The PDF goes with it
- **One email per result type** (4 emails). Each has a slot for:

  - a **priority domain block** (6 blocks, 6.3): what to fix first, how we would take it, proof, and what they leave the call with. With no blockers, the block uses the lowest scoring domain
  - **overlay lines** (6.4) when they apply
- **Sender:** a named person, not "the xLoop team".

  [CONFIRM] who signs: suggest the data lead for Data and AI blocks, the security lead for Safe blocks
- **Button:** keeps the booking's one name across the site ("30 minute Data & AI Readiness Review"); the line above it names what they get
- **Not sent to:** excluded leads (learners get an xCelerate email instead), NEPRA cases (phone and email only)
- Priority A leads still get this email; sales follows up personally within 1 business day
- Merge fields: `{first_name}` `{initiative}` (X1 answer in plain words) `{data}` `{ai}` `{safe}` `{blocker_count}` `{blocker_names}` `{notsure_count}`

6.2 The four emails

Email 1: Starting Out

Subject: Your readiness result: start with one question worth answering
Preview: The first three choices matter more than any tool.

> Hi {first_name},
>
> Your full report is attached. Your scores: Data Foundation {data}%, AI Delivery {ai}%, Safe to Scale {safe}%.
>
> You are early on both sides. That is common, and it is a good place to be honest about. It means your first three choices decide how the rest goes: which initiative, which data, and who owns it. Skip them and a pilot can end up with nobody to fund the rollout.
>
> {PRIORITY DOMAIN BLOCK}
>
> {OVERLAY LINES}
>
> In 30 minutes, one of our engineers will turn your answers into a first initiative with an owner, a success measure and the data it needs. Nothing more to prepare. Bring your report.
>
> **[Book my 30 minute Readiness Review]**
>
> {sender_name}
>
> {sender_title}, xLoop Digital
>
> P.S. Not ready for a call? Reply with the one question you most want answered, and an engineer will answer it by email.

Email 2: Data Ready, AI Not Started

Subject: Your data is ahead of your AI plans
Preview: The foundation most companies are still building is already there.

> Hi {first_name},
>
> Your full report is attached. Your scores: Data Foundation {data}%, AI Delivery {ai}%, Safe to Scale {safe}%.
>
> You have the foundation most companies are still building. What is missing sits on the AI side: a chosen initiative, someone who will fund the rollout, and a number that proves it worked.
>
> So the next step is not more data work. It is choosing the first use case your data can already support, and agreeing the number that would justify scaling it.
>
> {PRIORITY DOMAIN BLOCK}
>
> {OVERLAY LINES}
>
> In 30 minutes, one of our engineers will match your data to the use cases it can support today, and you leave with the first one to build and the measure to judge it by.
>
> **[Book my 30 minute Readiness Review]**
>
> {sender_name}
>
> {sender_title}, xLoop Digital
>
> P.S. Not ready for a call? Reply with the one question you most want answered, and an engineer will answer it by email.

Email 3: AI Ahead of the Data

Subject: You are ready to build. Your data is not, yet.

Preview: This is where AI projects quietly stall.

> Hi {first_name},
>
> Your full report is attached. Your scores: Data Foundation {data}%, AI Delivery {ai}%, Safe to Scale {safe}%.
>
> You have the intent, the sponsor and often the team. The gap is underneath: data that is hard to reach, or numbers people do not agree on. This is where AI projects quietly stall. The pilot works, then nobody trusts what it produces.
>
> The answer is not to pause {initiative}. Fix the specific data it depends on, in parallel with a narrow pilot, not after it.
>
> {PRIORITY DOMAIN BLOCK}
>
> {OVERLAY LINES}
>
> In 30 minutes, one of our data engineers will trace {initiative} back to the data it needs, and you leave knowing what to fix first and what can run in parallel.
>
> **[Book my 30 minute Readiness Review]**
>
> {sender_name}
>
> {sender_title}, xLoop Digital
>
> P.S. Not ready for a call? Reply with the one question you most want answered, and an engineer will answer it by email.

Email 4: Ready to Scale

Subject: Your foundations are there. What do you scale first?

Preview: The risk now is the next rollout, not the first one.

> Hi {first_name},
>
> Your full report is attached. Your scores: Data Foundation {data}%, AI Delivery {ai}%, Safe to Scale {safe}%.
>
> You scored ready on both data and AI. That puts you ahead of most teams we assess. The question now is which initiative to scale next, and whether it holds up against your production controls before it reaches more people.
>
> {PRIORITY DOMAIN BLOCK}
>
> {OVERLAY LINES}
>
> In 30 minutes, one of our engineers will pressure test your next rollout against your answers, and you leave with what to scale first and what could slow it down.
>
> **[Book my 30 minute Readiness Review]**
>
> {sender_name}
>
> {sender_title}, xLoop Digital
>
> P.S. Not ready for a call? Reply with the one question you most want answered, and an engineer will answer it by email.

6.3 Priority domain blocks (one drops into the slot)

Data Trust & Meaning

> **What to fix first: numbers your teams agree on.** When two teams report the same number and get different answers, any AI built on top inherits the argument.
>
> How we would take it:
>
> 1. Pick the three numbers that matter most to {initiative}.
> 2. Trace each one to its sources, then agree one definition and one owner.
> 3. Automate the reconciliation, so the agreed number refreshes without anyone rebuilding it by hand.
>
> We did this for one of the largest asset management companies in Pakistan, replacing manual spreadsheet reconciliation with automated matching and exception reporting.

Data Access & Integration

> **What to fix first: getting to the data without manual work.** The data {initiative} needs takes manual work to reach today. That cost rarely appears in a budget, but it appears in every reporting cycle.
>
> How we would take it:

1. List every source {initiative} needs, who owns it, and how to reach it.
2. Automate the two or three manual pulls that repeat every cycle.
3. Agree one standard way for your core systems to connect to new tools.

We moved a {descriptor} off legacy RPG applications onto private cloud with minimal disruption.

Use Case & Value

What to fix first: one initiative with a funded owner. A pilot without an agreed success measure, or without someone to pay for the rollout, tends to end as a demo.

How we would take it:

1. Score your shortlist on value, data readiness and risk.
2. Choose one, with a named owner and a success measure such as hours saved or cost per case.
3. Write the one page rollout case, and agree who funds it before the pilot starts.

{PROOF: A12 or A18 depending on the initiative}

Delivery Capability

What to fix first: who builds it, and how it reaches users. Your answers point to a gap in {team capacity / how new work gets released}. They need different fixes, and your report separates the two.

How we would take it:

1. Decide what stays in house and what to bring in.
2. Fill the missing skills first, usually data engineering or LLM engineering.
3. Set go or no go criteria for every pilot, and a release path that gets new work to users in weeks.

We scaled a platform for a {descriptor} past 10,000 users at 99.9% uptime.

Shadow AI & Data Protection

What to fix first: what data leaves through AI tools. If your teams already use public AI tools, the real question is what data goes with them. Your answers say you cannot fully see that yet.

How we would take it:

1. Find the AI tools in use today, including browser extensions and AI features inside tools you already pay for.
2. Give staff an approved tool, and block or log sensitive data pasted into public ones.
3. Test that access rights hold before any assistant sits on your documents.

Our assessments are led by certified ISO 27001 and ISO/IEC 42001 Lead Auditors.

Closing line and button for this block replace the profile's: In 30 minutes, our security lead will scope an AI Security Assessment around your answers, and you leave with the first three controls to put in place. **[Book my AI Security Assessment call]**

Governance & Oversight

What to fix first: who approves AI going live, and what checks its answers. Done well, governance makes approvals faster. Right now, AI can go live without a clear sign off, or its answers can reach people without a check.

How we would take it:

1. Add one go live approval step with business, security and legal sign off.
2. Map the rules that apply to you (data protection law, your sector regulator) and give each an owner.
3. Set checks for AI answers before release, with an owner and a tested way to switch off or roll back.

Our assessments are led by certified ISO 27001 and ISO/IEC 42001 Lead Auditors.

Closing line and button for this block replace the profile's: In 30 minutes, our security lead will walk your first use case through a go live approval step, and you leave with the checks its answers need before release. **[Book my AI Security Assessment call]**

6.4 Overlay lines (added in this order, after the block)

- **P1 = Yes, often** (goes at the very top, after "Hi"): "You told us missing or wrong data has caused delays, errors or lost deals more than once this year. Your report starts there."
- **Blockers found:** "We found {blocker_count} things likely to stall this before it reaches production: {blocker_names}. The fix for each one is in your report."

- **Guardrails behind** (only when the block is not a Safe block): "One more thing. Your Safe to Scale score is {safe}%, so your guardrails are behind your plans. That is cheaper to fix before anything reaches customers, and we can cover it on the same call."
- **Low visibility** (3–5 "Not sure"): "You were not sure about {notsure_count} answers. That is worth knowing in itself, and your report suggests who inside your organization could answer each one."
- **Provisional** (6+ "Not sure", replaces the line above): "You were not sure about {notsure_count} answers, so treat these scores as a starting point. A 30 minute review is the quickest way to fill the gaps."

7. Questions for Irfan and the engineers

- ☐ **Questions and answer scales:** any wording that a CIO or head of data would read differently than we intend?
- ☐ **Scoring:** agree that "Not sure" is left out of the score (still flags blockers), and that 6+ "Not sure" makes the result provisional
- ☐ **Thresholds:** 50% on each axis, blocker at 0–1. Fine for launch, review after 50 completions?
- ☐ **"How we would take it" steps:** are these the steps you would actually run? Change anything you would not do
- ☐ **What the 30-minute review covers:** each email promises a specific output ("you leave with…"). Can an engineer deliver that in 30 minutes from the report alone?
- ☐ **AI Security Assessment:** the routing tab says it is built; the 27 Oct security page note says `/ai-security-assessment` returned 404. Which link does the Safe button go to?
- ☐ **Proof:** confirm the anonymous descriptors for A14 (legacy RPG) and A11 (10,000 users), and pick A12 or A18 for Use Case & Value
- ☐ **P.S. reply promise:** who answers the email replies, and how fast?
- ☐ **Sender:** who signs the Data/AI emails and who signs the Safe emails